

## Title of the Research

*Evaluating Commercial Facial Analysis Algorithms*

## Principal Investigators

- [redacted]

## Key Information About the Study

Your permission is being sought for your child's participation in research. Participation in the research is voluntary.

The purpose of this research is to evaluate the usability and efficacy of commercial facial analysis services. *Participating in the study will take up to either 60 minutes or 90 minutes, depending on the length of time that you signed up for.*

If your child participates, we will take photos and videos of their face that we will use to evaluate commercial facial analysis algorithms. These algorithms commonly attempt to determine whether a photo or video is of a real person's face and approximate how old they are.

We may vary the lighting, ask your child to pose in a particular posture, or provide them with materials to alter their appearance (e.g., glasses or a wig). These steps will enable us to test how commercial facial analysis algorithms respond to changes in a person's appearance. We will not provide feedback to your child about how algorithms responded to these changes.

We will not ask your child to sign up for or interact with any online service, and the only information about them that we may provide to a service is photos and videos of their face. We will take steps to ensure that this information is not used for any other purposes and is promptly deleted after the study. We will also promptly delete any photos or videos we collect after the study.

*At the end of your child's participation, we will ask them to complete a brief survey about their demographics and use of online services.*

**On the next page, please carefully review the Explanation of Risks to Minor Participants, which describes two categories of risks associated with this study: collection of images and videos and online age checks.** We believe these are minimal risks, with low likelihood and magnitude, that are consistent with everyday activities.

**This study has been approved by the [redacted] IRB.**

## **Explanation of Risks to Minor Participants**

### **1. Collected Images and Videos**

In order to study commercial facial analysis algorithms, we will collect images and videos of your child's face. We will protect this information on devices that we own and only we have access to, using strong encryption, authentication, and other security measures. We will not disclose images or videos of your child, with the one exception that we describe here.

Commercial facial analysis algorithms are commonly deployed as a service, where analyzing an image or video requires submitting a copy for automated analysis. We can only study these algorithms by submitting images and videos rather than running the analysis on our devices.

We will only submit images or videos collected in this study to a commercial service if it commits to the following stringent data protection requirements: 1) The service immediately deletes images and videos after automated analysis, not storing them at all. 2) The service solely uses the images and videos for automated analysis, not repurposing them in any way or allowing its employees to access them. 3) The service protects submitted images and videos with strong encryption, authentication, and other safeguards, consistent with a rigorous industry standard. 4) An independent auditor has confirmed that the service has implemented these requirements.

We believe the risk of a service data breach involving images or videos of your child's face is low, and in the unlikely event of a breach, the magnitude of impact would also be low both because of the innocuous nature of the images and because we will not disclose your or your child's name or contact information. We will immediately notify you, to the extent possible, if we become aware of a data breach.

### **2. Age Checks**

A goal of this research project is to understand how accurately commercial facial analysis algorithms can assess a person's age, including when the person takes steps to change their appearance in ways that may make them look older. For example, we may ask your child to put on glasses or a wig. The results from these algorithms are sometimes used by apps and websites to check a person's age and restrict access or functionality for minors.

We will not ask your child to interact with or attempt to bypass any age check. The study environment will be similar to a photo shoot, where we provide verbal instructions and take pictures and video of your child's face in various poses and with various props. We will not tell your child which algorithms we are testing, what the algorithms do, how we are testing the algorithms, which apps or websites use the algorithms, or how they use the algorithms. We also will not show your child any of the photos or videos that we collect, live feeds from the cameras that we use, or any analysis or result displays.

We have carefully designed this study to minimize the risk that your child will learn strategies for attempting to bypass age checks, and we believe the remaining risk is minimal. We will separately provide you with references for learning more about children's online safety.

**This study has been approved by the [redacted] IRB.**

**We will only proceed with this study if you grant permission and your child also consents. You or your child may ask to skip any part of the study, and you or your child may also withdraw from the study at any time.**

This research aims to advance the science of facial analysis algorithms and inform the development of public policy related to facial analysis.

We are not aware of any alternative procedures for participation that may be advantageous to your child.

## **Confidentiality**

All records from this study will be kept confidential. Your child's responses will be kept private, and we will not include any information that will make it possible to identify your child in any report we might publish.

The only identifiable information about your child that we may disclose consists of photos and videos of their face, for the sole purpose of testing commercial facial analysis algorithms, and only as necessary. As described in the attached explanation of risks, we are implementing substantial safeguards to prevent the storage, disclosure, or reuse of these photos and videos by the services that we test. We will not disclose your child's name or other contact information to these services or to anyone else.

We will store our research records securely on password-protected computers. The research team will be the only party that will have access to our research records. We will not use or distribute your child's personal information for future research studies.

## **Compensation**

If your child participates in a 60-minute study session, they will receive a \$30 Amazon gift card. If your child participates in a 90-minute study session, they will receive a \$45 Amazon gift card.

## **Who to Contact with Questions**

You may contact the research team at: [redacted].

If you have questions regarding your child's rights as a research subject, or if problems arise which you do not feel you can discuss with the Investigator, please contact the Institutional Review Board at:

Phone: [redacted]

Email: [redacted]

## **Participating in the Study**

**This study has been approved by the [redacted] IRB.**

If you would like your child to have a choice to participate, before beginning the study, we will ask you to confirm the following:

- Your child's participation in this study is voluntary.
- We will only proceed with the study with\ your permission and your child's assent. We will provide a similar form to your child, and we will ask for their assent.
- If you or your child decide to not proceed with the study, there will be no loss of benefits to which you or your child are otherwise entitled.
- You or your child may discontinue participation at any time without penalty or loss of benefits.
- You or your child may skip any part of the study without penalty or loss of benefits.
- You do not waive any legal rights or release [redacted] or its agents from liability for negligence.
- You give your permission, as the child's parent or guardian, to participate in this research.

By signing below, I confirm that I have read and understand all the information provided in this form. I accept the terms outlined in this form and grant permission for my child to participate in the study.

Child's name (print): \_\_\_\_\_

Parent/guardian name (print): \_\_\_\_\_

Parent/guardian signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

**This study has been approved by the [redacted] IRB.**